

FUND FOR INNOVATION IN DEVELOPMENT (FID) — APPLICATION

Up to €4,000,000 | Rolling Deadline | Submitted via: fundinnovation.wiin.io

Applicant: BETONIQ WEST LTD — ZerôPâÿ Money
Shareholder & CEO: Tom Ugbodaga
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Portal: fundinnovation.wiin.io

PROJECT TITLE: ZerôPâÿ Money — Offline-First Payment Infrastructure for Global Financial Inclusion

REQUESTED AMOUNT: €3,200,000

INNOVATION CATEGORY: Financial Inclusion / Digital Economy / Poverty Reduction

GEOGRAPHY: Nigeria (Phase 1) → West Africa (Phase 2) → Global (Phase 3) — the architecture is connectivity-agnostic and deploys identically in any low-connectivity environment worldwide, from informal markets to disaster zones to developed-market network outages.

THE OPPORTUNITY

1.4 billion people globally are unbanked or severely underbanked — 38 million of them in Nigeria alone. This is the hook and the proof point for a universal problem, not a regional one. Every digital payment system in existence — mobile money, QR codes, NFC, USSD, payment apps — requires an active internet or mobile network connection to complete a transaction. In the 68 countries where the Fund for Innovation in Development operates, and in developed markets during network outages or disaster response, this single dependency excludes hundreds of millions of the most economically vulnerable people from the digital economy.

THE INNOVATION

ZerôPâÿ Money is the world's first offline-first, uncapped NFC contactless payment protocol. It enables merchants to accept fully authenticated digital payments of any value with zero internet connectivity, using a patent-pending four-layer cryptographic architecture that processes, authenticates, and queues transactions entirely offline, then batch-settles them to any connected payment rail once connectivity is briefly restored. This is not an incremental improvement — it removes the single structural barrier that has capped every prior financial inclusion effort: connectivity dependency.

TECHNICAL SUMMARY

Layer 1 — NFC Communication: ISO 14443-A/B contactless protocol. Customer taps any NFC device (phone, card, wearable) to a ZerôPâÿ terminal. No app. No internet. 4cm range.

Layer 2 — PUF Hardware Authentication: Physical Unclonable Function — a silicon fingerprint burned into the terminal chip at manufacturing. Offline device identity verification, mathematically non-clonable, no server required.

Layer 3 — ECC P-256 Offline Signing: Elliptic Curve Cryptography, central-bank grade. Transaction signed entirely on the terminal processor, offline. Non-repudiable, no server required.

Layer 4 — Distance Bounding Protocol: Nanosecond signal timing prevents relay attacks, the most sophisticated class of NFC fraud — first implementation at point-of-sale scale globally.

Batch Settlement Engine: Signed tokens queue offline. On connectivity restoration, batches transmit to any settlement rail (Paystack Nigeria / Flutterwave Ghana / Stripe UK / Orange Money Sierra Leone). PSP-agnostic — no transaction is ever lost.

Solar Mesh Hub: For zero-connectivity environments: a solar-powered LoRaWAN mesh relay network propagates signed batches 2-15km per hop. No mobile network required.

DEPLOYMENT PLAN & BUDGET

Phase	Scope	Amount
Phase 1 — Nigeria (Months 1-18)	200-terminal pilot in Abuja informal markets, 3 Solar Mesh Hubs, 120 agents, Paystack settlement rail	€1,200,000
Phase 2 — West Africa (Months 12-36)	Expansion into Ghana, Sierra Leone and a 3rd West African market, 500 agents, multi-rail settlement	€1,000,000
Phase 3 — Global Infrastructure Rollout (Months 24-36)	24-hour cross-border/developed-market deployment, 100 agents, partnerships with global PSPs	€1,000,000
Total		€3,200,000

How to read this table: Amounts are total capital requested per phase, in euros (€), covering hardware (terminals, Solar Mesh Hubs), field operations (agent salaries, onboarding), and regulatory/compliance costs. Phases run partially in parallel (Phase 2 begins at Month 12, before Phase 1 concludes at Month 18) to maintain momentum. No revenue offset is assumed in this budget — all €3.2M is treated as deployment capital, with settlement fee revenue (via Paystack and future PSSP licensing) modelled as separate, additive income.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

By Month 18 (end of Nigeria phase): 1.2 million previously unbanked individuals with first-ever digital payment access, via 200 ZéroPâ money merchants each serving an average of 6,000 customers/month. An estimated ₦15,000,000/month in newly formalized settlement volume from previously invisible cash. 200 merchants with first-ever digital transaction histories, now credit-scoring eligible. 38 new community tech jobs created (Terminal Agents + Mesh Hub Operators).

By Month 36 (West Africa phase complete): 4 countries with active ZéroPâ Money infrastructure, 5,000 merchants onboarded, an estimated 3 million low-income individuals with first digital payment access, and a demonstrated replication playbook for 20+ additional markets globally.

FOUNDER CREDENTIALS

Tom Ugboaga — Shareholder & CEO, BETONI WEST LTD
MSc Computer Systems Security (University of Gloucestershire - England, 2011)
LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/tom-deggs-ugboaga-2306692bb](https://www.linkedin.com/in/tom-deggs-ugboaga-2306692bb)
This is a 15-year research commercialisation. Tom's postgraduate research and dissertation

focused directly on the scientific disciplines underpinning ZerôPây Money's architecture — NFC security and applied cryptography — giving this venture a rare direct line from academic research to deployable infrastructure.

BETONIQ WEST LTD — RC 1496603, Abuja, FCT, Nigeria. Paystack Merchant Agreement signed — July 14, 2026. Patent-pending invention disclosure — April 2026. Security architecture formally verified via TLA+ model checking (437 states explored, 0 violations found).

ALIGNMENT WITH FID MANDATE

The Fund for Innovation in Development funds innovations with the potential to combat poverty and inequality at scale, worldwide. ZerôPây Money is structurally aligned with this mandate:

- It targets the poorest and most economically excluded populations globally — informal market traders, subsistence merchants, day labourers — excluded not by choice but by the architecture of existing systems, in any country.
- It is universally scalable — the protocol works identically in any country, with any settlement rail, any currency, and any connectivity condition, from rural sub-Saharan markets to disaster-response zones to developed-market network outages.
- It generates measurable poverty-reduction impact — merchants who receive digital payments build transaction histories, unlocking access to credit and formal financial services for the first time.

CLOSING

The Fund for Innovation in Development has the opportunity to fund the foundational infrastructure layer of global financial inclusion — not another app, not another mobile wallet, but the infrastructure layer every future financial inclusion solution will build upon.

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